

For the 5-14 age group the Census figure of 2,141,671 children attending school is less than the Education Ministry figure of 2,406,201 pupils enrolled in school by 264,530 or 11.0 percent. It is unlikely that there has been a tendency to understate or suppress the fact that a child was attending school. The difference is most probably due to a substantial number of pupils who were on the registers in March 1971 having ceased to attend school in August/September 1971.

In the case of the pupils aged 15-24, however, the Census figure of 578,072 exceeds the Education Ministry figure of 396,135 by 181,937 or 46 percent. The Education Ministry figure represents only those enrolled in schools while the Census figures also include enrolment in the Universities and other higher educational institutions, such as, technical schools, vocational schools etc. and private institutions such as tutorials etc. but it does not seem likely that attendance at those institutions could account for the rather larger difference of 181,937. It is therefore likely that there was a tendency on the part of some persons in this age group to report themselves as attending school when in fact they were not doing so. Some young persons who had ceased their education but not yet found employment would have reported themselves as still in school.

TABLE 8.7 : PERCENTAGE OF CHILDREN ATTENDING SCHOOL BY SEX AND SINGLE YEARS OF AGE FOR URBAN AND RURAL SECTOR 1971.

Age	Both Sectors			Urban Sector			Rural Sector		
	Total	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female
5	15.6	15.7	15.4	16.4	16.4	16.4	15.4	15.5	15.2
6	60.1	60.8	59.4	62.4	62.6	62.1	59.5	60.3	58.7
7	73.3	74.1	72.5	76.7	77.3	76.1	72.4	73.2	71.5
8	76.8	77.8	75.8	80.1	60.5	79.6	76.0	77.0	74.9
9	79.1	80.3	77.8	82.1	83.1	81.1	78.1	79.6	76.9
10	78.1	79.8	76.4	81.4	82.6	80.2	77.2	79.0	75.4
11	77.4	79.6	75.1	82.0	83.2	80.7	76.2	78.7	73.4
12	69.3	71.6	66.8	75.1	76.6	73.5	67.7	70.3	64.9
13	64.9	67.8	61.9	72.3	74.2	70.3	62.8	66.0	59.5
14	57.2	60.2	54.2	65.7	67.5	63.7	54.9	58.1	51.6
15	51.0	53.4	48.5	60.3	62.5	58.0	48.3	50.7	54.8
16	43.2	45.7	40.8	52.9	55.5	50.1	40.5	42.7	38.2
17	35.2	37.1	33.3	43.6	46.0	40.9	32.7	34.3	31.2
18	24.2	25.9	22.5	30.2	32.3	27.8	22.5	23.9	21.0
19	18.8	20.2	17.3	23.8	25.1	22.2	17.2	18.5	15.9
20	12.6	13.8	11.4	16.8	18.0	15.4	11.2	12.3	10.2
21	10.4	11.1	9.7	14.1	14.7	13.4	9.2	9.8	8.6
22	7.7	8.4	7.0	11.5	12.0	10.9	6.5	7.1	5.9
23	6.3	6.9	5.7	9.6	10.1	8.9	5.2	5.7	5.9
24	5.2	5.9	4.6	8.2	8.7	7.6	4.2	4.8	3.7

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